

NOTES AND QUERIES:

A MEDIUM OF INTER-COMMUNICATION

FOR

LITERARY MEN, ARTISTS, ANTIQUARIES, GENEALOGISTS, ETC.

—————

"When found, make a note of."—CAPTAIN CUTLER.

VOL. IV.—No. 99.] SATURDAY, SEPTEMBER 20. 1851.

{ Price Threepence.
{ Stamped Edition, 4d.

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Notes and Queries, Vol. IV, Number 99, September 20, 1851

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Saxon characters have been marked in braces as in {Eafel}.

CONTENTS.

NOTES:—

Venerable Bede's Mental Arithmetic [201](#)

Hyphenism, Hyphenic, Hyphenization [203](#)

Gray and Cowley [204](#)

Minor Notes:—'Υπωπιάζω—Meaning of Whitsunday—Anagrammatic Pun by William Oldys—Ballad of Chevy Chase: Ovid—Horace Walpole at Eton [205](#)

QUERIES:—

Continental Watchmen and their Songs [206](#)

Minor Queries:—Quotation from Bacon—Carmagnoles—The Use of Tobacco by the Elizabethan Ladies—Covines—Story referred to by Jeremy Taylor—Plant in Texas—Discount—Sacre Cheveux—"Mad as a March Hare"—Payments for Destruction of Vermin—Fire unknown—Matthew Paris's Historia Minor—Mother Bunche's Fairy Tales—Monumental Symbolism—Meaning of "Stickle" and "Dray"—Son of the Morning—Gild Book [208](#)

REPLIES:—

Pope and Flatman [209](#)

Test of the Strength of a Bow [210](#)

Baskerville the Printer [211](#)

Replies to Minor Queries:—Mazer Wood and Sin-eaters—"A Posie of other Men's Flowers"—Table Book—Briwingable—Simnels—A Ship's Berth—Suicides buried in Cross-roads—A Sword-blade Note—Domesday Book of Scotland—Dole-bank—The Letter "V"—Cardinal Wolsey—Nervous—Coleridge's Essays on Beauty—"Nao" or "Naw," a Ship—Unde derivatur Stonehenge—Nick Nack—Meaning of Carfax—Hand giving the Benediction—Unlucky for Pregnant Women to take an Oath—Borough-English—Date of a Charter [211](#)

MISCELLANEOUS:—

Notes on Books, Sales, Catalogues, &c. [215](#)

Books and Odd Volumes wanted [215](#)

Notices to Correspondents [215](#)

Advertisements [216](#)

[List of Notes and Queries volumes and pages](#)

Notes.

VENERABLE BEDE'S MENTAL ALMANAC.

If our own ancient British sage, the Venerable Bede, could rise up from the dust of eleven centuries, he might find us, notwithstanding all our astounding improvements, in a worse position, in one respect at least, than when he left us; and as the subject would be one in which he was well versed, it would indubitably attract his attention.

He might then set about teaching us from his own writings a mental resource, far superior to any similar device practised by ourselves, by which the day of the week belonging to any day of the month, in any year of the Christian era, might easily and speedily be found.

And when the few, who would give themselves the trouble of thoroughly understanding it, came to perceive its easiness of acquirement, its simplicity in practice, and its firm hold upon the memory, they might well marvel how so admirable a facility should have been so entirely forgotten, or by what perversion of judgment it could have been superseded by the comparatively clumsy and impracticable method of the Dominical letters.

Let us hear his description of it in his own words:

"QUÆ SIT FERIA IN CALENDIS.

"Simile autem huic tradunt argumentum ad inveniendam diem Calendarum promptissimum.

"Habet ergo regulares Ianuarius II, Februarius V, Martius V, Apriles I, Maius III, Junius VI, Julius I, Augustus IIII, September VII, October II, November V, December VII. Qui videlicet regulares hoc specialiter indicant, quota sit feria per Calendas, eo anno quo septem concurrentes adscripti sunt dies: cæteris vero annis addes concurrentes quotquot in præsentī fuerunt adnotati ad regulares mensium singulorum, et ita diem calendarum sine errore semper inuenies. Hoc tantum memor esto, ut cum imminente anno bisextili unus concurrentium intermittendus est dies, eo tamen numero quem intermissurus es in Ianuario Februarioque utaris: ac in calendis primum Martiis per illum qui circulo centinetur solis computare incipias. Cum ergo diem calendarum, verbi gratia, Ianuarium, quærere vis; dicis Ianuarius II, adde concurrentes septimanæ dies qui fuerunt anno quo computas, utpote III, fiunt quinque; quinta feria intrant calendæ Ianuariæ. Item anno qui sex habet concurrentes, sume V regulares mensis Martii, adde concurrentes sex, fiunt undecim, tolle septem, remanent quatuor, quarta feria sunt Calendæ Martiæ."—Bede Venerabilis, *De Temporum Ratione*, caput XXI.

The meaning of this may be expressed as follows:—Attached to the twelve months of the year are certain fixed numbers called regulars, ranging from I to VII, denoting the days of the week in their usual order. These regulars, in any year whereof the concurrent, or solar epact, is 0 or 7, express, of themselves, the commencing day of each month: but in other years, whatever the solar epact of the year may be, that epact must be added to the regular of any month to indicate, in a similar manner, the commencing day of that month.

It follows, therefore, that the only burthen the memory need be charged with is the distribution of the regulars among the several months; because the other element, the solar epact (which also ranges from 1 to 7), may either be obtained from a short mental calculation, or, should the system come into general use, it would soon become a matter of public notoriety during the continuance of each current year.

Now, these solar epacts have several practical advantages over the Dominical letters. 1. They are numerical in themselves, and therefore they are found at once, and used directly, without the complication of converting

figures into letters and letters into figures. 2. They increase progressively in every year; whereas the Dominical letters have a crab-like retrogressive progress, which impedes facility of practice. 3. The *rationale* of the solar epacts is more easily explained and more readily understood: they are the accumulated odd days short of a complete week; consequently the accumulation must increase by 1 in every year, except in leap years, when it increases by 2; because in leap years there are 2 odd days over 52 complete weeks. But this irregularity in the epact of leap year does not come into operation until the additional day has actually been added to the year; that is, not until after the 29th of February. Or, as Bede describes it, "*in leap years one of the concurrent days is intermitted, but the number so intermitted must be used for January and February; after which, the epact obtained from cyclical tables (or from calculation) must be used for the remaining months.*" By which he means, that the epacts increase in arithmetical succession, except in leap years, when the series is interrupted by one number being passed over; the number so passed over being used for January and February only. Thus, 2 being the epact of 1851, 3 would be its natural successor for 1852; but, in consequence of this latter being leap year, 3 is intermitted (except for January and February), and 4 becomes the real epact, as obtained from calculation.

To calculate the solar epact for any year, Bede in another place gives the following rule:

"Si vis scire concurrentes septimanæ dies, sume annos Domini et eorum quartum partem adjice: his quoque quatuor adde, (quia) quinque concurrentes fuerunt anno Nativitatis Domini: hos partire per septem et remanent Epactæ Solis."

That is: take the given year, add to it its fourth part, and also the constant number 4 (which was the epact preceding the first year of the Christian era), divide the sum by 7, and what remains is the solar epact. (If there be no remainder, the epact may be called either 0 or 7.)

This is an excellent rule; the same, I believe, that is to this day prescribed for arriving at the Dominical letter of the Old Style. Let it be applied, for example, to find upon what day of the week the battle of Agincourt was fought (Oct. 25, 1415). Here we have 1415, and its fourth 353, and the constant 4, which together make 1772, divided by 7 leaves 1 as the solar epact; and this, added to 2, the *regular* for the month of October, informs us that 3, or Tuesday, was the first day of that month; consequently it was the 22nd, and Friday, the 25th, was Saint Crispin's day.

But this rule of Bede's, in consequence of the addition, since his time, of a thousand years to the number to be operated upon, is no longer so convenient as a *mental* resource.

It may be greatly simplified by separating the centuries from the odd years, by which the operation is reduced to two places of figures instead of four. Such a method, moreover, has the very great advantage of assimilating the operation of finding the solar epact, in both styles, the Old and the New; the only remaining difference between them being in the rules for finding the *constant number* to be added in each century. These rules are as follow:—

For the Old Style.—In any date, divide the number of centuries by 7, and deduct the remainder from 4 (or 11); the result is the constant for that century.

For the New Style.—In any date, divide the number of centuries by 4, double the remainder, and deduct it from 6: the result is the constant for that century.

For the Solar Epact, in either Style.—To the odd years of any date (rejecting the centuries) add their fourth part, and also the constant number found by the preceding rules; divide the sum by 7, and what remains is the solar epact.

As an example of these rules in *Old Style*, let the former example be repeated, viz. A.D. 1415:

First, since the centuries (14), divided by 7, leave no remainder, 4 is the constant number. Therefore 15, and 3 (the fourth), and 4 (the constant), amount to 22, from which eliminating the sevens, remains 1 as the solar epact.

For an example in *New Style*, let the present year be taken. In the first place, 18 divided by 4 leaves 2, which doubled is 4, deducted from 6 results 2, the constant number for the present century. Therefore 51, and 12 (the fourth), and 2 (the constant), together make 65, from which the sevens being eliminated, remains 2, the solar epact for this year.

But in appreciating the practical facility of this method, we must bear in mind that *the constant*, when once ascertained for any century, remains unchanged throughout the whole of that century; and that *the solar epact*, when once ascertained for any year, can scarcely require recalculation during the remainder of that year: furthermore, that although the rule for calculating the epact, as just recited, is so extremely simple, yet even that slight mental exertion may be spared to the mass of those who might benefit by its application to current purposes; because it might become an object of general notoriety in each current year. And I am not without hope that "NOTES AND QUERIES" will next year set the example to other publications, by making the current solar epact for 1852 a portion of its "heading," and by suffering it to remain, incorporated with the date of each impression, throughout the year.

Let us now recur to the allotment of *the regulars* at the beginning of Bede's description. Placed in succession their order is as follows:—

April and July	I,	or Sunday
January and October	II,	or Monday
May	III,	or Tuesday
August	IIII,	or Wednesday
March, Feb., and November	V,	or Thursday
June	VI,	or Friday
September and December	VII,	or Saturday

There is no great difficulty in retaining this in the memory; but should uncertainty arise at any time, it may be immediately corrected by a mental reference to the following lines, the alliterative jingle of which is designed to house them as securely in the brain as the immortal and never-failing, "Thirty days hath September." The order of the allotment is preserved by appropriating as nearly as possible a line to each day of the week; while the absolute connexion here and there of certain days, by name, with certain months, forms a sort of interweaving that renders mistake or misplacement almost impossible.

"April loveth to link with July,
And the merry new year with October comes by,
August for Wednesday, Tuesday for May,
March and November and Valentine's Day,
Friday is June day, and lastly we seek
September and Christmas to finish the week."

Now, since we have ascertained, from the short calculation before recited, that the solar epact of this present year of 1851 is 2, and since the regular of October is also 2, we have but to add them together to obtain 4 (or Wednesday) as the commencing day of this next coming month of October. And, if we wish to know the day of the month belonging to any other day of the week in October, we have but to subtract the commencing day, which is 4, from 8, and to the result add the required day. Let the latter, for example, be Sunday; then 4 from 8 leaves 4, which added to 1 (or Sunday), shows that Sunday, in the month of October 1851, is either 5th, 12th, 19th, or 26th.

This additional application is here introduced merely to illustrate the great facilities afforded by the purely numerical form of Bede's "*argumentum*,"—such as must gradually present themselves to any person who will take the trouble to become thoroughly and practically familiar with it.

A. E. B.

Leeds, September, 1851.

HYPHENISM, HYPHENIC, HYPHENIZATION.

Where our ancestors wanted words, they made them, or imported them ready made. But we are become so particular about the etymological force of newly coined words, that we can never please ourselves, but rather

choose to do without than to tolerate anything exceptionable. We have to learn again that a word cannot be like Burleigh's nod, but must be content to indicate the whole by the expression of some prominent part, or of some convenient part, prominent or not.

Among the uses to which the "NOTES AND QUERIES" might be put, is the suggestion of words. It very often happens that one who is apt at finding the want is not equally good for the remedy, and *vice versâ*. By the aid of this journal the blade might find a handle, or the handle a blade, as wanted, with the advantage of criticism at the formation; while an author who coins a word, must commit himself before he can have much advice.

The above remarks were immediately suggested by my happening to think of a word for a thing which gives much trouble, and requires more attention than it has received, but not more than it may receive if it can be fitly designated by a single word. A *clause* of a sentence, both by etymology and usage, means any part of it of which the component words cannot be separated, but must all go together, or all remain together: it is then a component of the sentence which has a finished meaning in itself. The proper mode of indicating the clauses takes its name from the means, and not from the end: we say *punctuation*, not *clausification*. This may have been a misfortune, for it is possible that punctuation might have been better studied, if its name had imported its object. But there is another and a greater misfortune, arising from the total want of a name. In a sentence, not only do collections of words form minor sentences, but they also form compound words: sometimes eight or ten words are really only one. When two words are thus compounded, we use a hyphen: but those who have attempted to use more than one hyphen have been laughed out of the field; though perspicuity, logic, and algebra were all on their side. The *Morning Post* adopted this practice in former days; and Horace Smith (or James, as the case may be,) ridiculed them in a parody which speaks of "the not-a-bit-the-less-on-that-account-to-be-universally-detested monster Buonaparte." It is, I think, much to be regretted that the use of the hyphen is so restricted: for though, like the comma, it might be abused, yet the abuse would rather tend to clearness.

But, without introducing a further use of the hyphen, it would be desirable to have a distinct name for a combination of words; which, without being such a recognised and permanent compound as *apple-tree* or *man in the moon*, is nevertheless one word in the particular sentence in hand. And the name is easily found. The word hyphen being Greek (ὕψ' ἔν), and being made a substantive, we might join Greek suffixes to it, and speak of *hyphenisms* and *hyphenic* phrases. For example, the following I should call a hyphenic error. When the British Museum recently published *A Short Guide to that Portion of the Library of printed Books now open to the Public*, a review pronounced the title a misnomer; because the *books* are not open to the public, but are in locked glass cases. The reviewer read it "library of printed-books-now-open-to-the-public," instead of "library-of-printed-books now open to the public." And though in this case the reviewer was very palpably wrong, yet there are many cases in which a real ambiguity exists.

A neglect of mental hyphenization often leads to mistake as to an author's meaning, particularly in this age of morbid implication. For instance, a person writes something about "a Sunday or other day-for-which-there-is-a-special-service;" and is taken as meaning "a Sunday-or-other-day for which," &c. The odds are that some readers will suppose him, by speaking of Sundays *with* special service, to imply that some are *without*.

M.

GRAY AND COWLEY.

Some spirited publisher would confer a serious obligation on the classical world by bringing out an edition of Gray's *Poems*, with the parallel passages annexed. "Taking him for all in all," he is one of our most perfect poets: and though Collins might have rivalled him (under circumstances equally auspicious), he could have been surpassed by Milton alone. In 1786, Gilbert Wakefield attempted to do for Gray what Newton and Warton had done for Milton (and, for one, I thank him for it); but his illustrations, though almost all good and to the point, are generally from books which every ordinary reader knows off by heart. Besides, Wakefield is so very egotistical, and at times so very puerile, that he is too much for most people. However, his volume, *The Poems of Mr. Gray, with Notes*, by Gilbert Wakefield, B.A., late Fellow of Jesus College, Cambridge: London, 1786, would furnish a good substratum for the volume I am now recommending.

Not to speak of Milton's English poems and the great masterpieces of ancient times, with which so learned a scholar as Gray was, of course, familiar, he draws largely from the Greek anthology, from Nonnus, from Milton's Latin poems, from Cowley, and I had almost said from the prose works of Bishop Jeremy Taylor. His admiration of the great "Shakspeare of Divinity" is proved from a portion of one of his letters to Mason; and some other day I may furnish an illustration or two. Indeed, were any publisher to undertake the generous office I mention, I dare say that many a secret treasure would be unlocked, and many an "orient pearl at random strung" be forthcoming for his use. Let me first mention Gray's opinion of Cowley, and then add in confirmation one or two passages out of many. He says in a note to his "Ode on the Progress of Poesy:"

"We have had in our language not other odes of the sublime kind than that of Dryden 'On St. Cecilia's Day:' for Cowley (*who had his merit*) yet wanted *judgment, style, and harmony for such a task*. That of Pope is not worthy of so great a man."

We must submit to Gray's oracular sentence, for he himself was pre-eminently gifted in the three great qualities in which he declares the deficiency of Cowley (at least if we are to judge from his English poems; for the prosody of his Latin efforts seems sadly deficient). At times Cowley's "harmony" is not first-rate, and his "style" is deeply impregnated with the fantastic conceits of the day; but he is still a poet, and a great one too. And I think that in some of his writings Gray had Cowley evidently in mind; *e.g.* in the *epitaph* to his "Elegy in a Country Churchyard:"

"Large was his bounty, and his soul sincere,
Heaven did a recompence as largely send:
He gave to mis'ry (all he had) a tear;
He gained from Heav'n ('twas all he wish'd) a friend."

Cowley had previously written:

"Large was his soul; as large a soul as e'er
Submitted to *inform* a *body* here.
High as the place 'twas shortly in *Heav'n* to have,
But low, and humble as his *grave*.
So *high* that all the *virtues* there did come,
As to their chiefest seat,
Conspicuous, and great;
So *low* that for *me* too it made a room."

On the Death of Mr. William Hervey.
Miscellanies, page 18. London, 1669.

Again—

"The attick warbler pours her *throat*
Responsive to the cuckoo's note,
The *untaught* harmony of spring."

Gray, Ode I. *On the Spring*.

"Hadst thou all the charming notes
Of the wood's poetic *throats*."

Cowley, *Ode to the Swallow*.

"Teaching their Maker in their *untaught* lays."

Cowley, *Davideis* lib. i. sect 63. p. 20.

Again:

"Where'er the oak's thick branches stretch
A broader browner shade,
Where'er the rude and moss-grown beech

O'er canopies the glade,
Beside some water's rushy brink,
With me the Muse shall sit, and think," &c.
Gray, Ode I. *On the Spring*.

"O magnum Isacidum decus! O pulcherrima castra!
O arma ingentes olim paritura triumphos!
Non sic herbarum vario subridet Amictu,
Planities pictæ vallis, montisque supini
Clivus, perpetuis Cedrorum versibus altus.
Non sic æstivo quondam nitet hortus in anno,
Frondusque, fructusque ferens, formosa secundum
Flumina, mollis ubi viridisque supernatat umbra."
Cowley, *Davididos* lib. i. ad finem.

I do not mean that Gray may not have had other poets in his mind when writing these lines (for there is nothing new or uncommon about them); but rather a careful going over of Cowley's poems convinces me that Gray was sensible of his "merits," and often corrects his want of "judgment" by his own refined and most exquisite taste. I must give one more instance; and I think that Bishop Hall's allusion to his life at Emmanuel College, and Bishop Ridley's "Farewell to Pembroke Hall," must every one fall into the background before Cowley. Gray's poem ought to be too well known to require quoting:

"Ye distant spires, ye antique towers,
That crown the wat'ry glade,
Where grateful Science still adores
Her Henry's holy shade;
And ye that from the stately brow
Of Windsor's heights th' expanse below
Of grove, of lawn, of mead survey,
Whose turf, whose shade, whose flowers among
Wanders the hoary Thames along
His silver winding way.

"Ah, happy hills! ah, pleasing shade!
Ah, fields beloved in vain!
Where once my careless childhood stray'd,
A stranger yet to pain.
I feel the gales that from ye blow,
A momentary bliss bestow,
As waving fresh their gladsome wing,
My weary soul they seem to soothe,
And, redolent of joy and youth,
To breathe a second spring."
Ode III. *On a distant Prospect of Eton College*.

Cowley was educated at Trinity College, Cambridge; and if I rightly remember Bonney's *Life of Bishop Middleton*, his affecting allusions to Cambridge had the highest praise of that accomplished scholar and divine:

"O mihi jucundum Grantæ super omnia nomen!

O penitus toto corde receptus amor!
 O pulchræ sine luxu ædes, vitæque beatæ,
 Splendida paupertas, ingenuusque decor!
 O chara ante alias, magnorum nomine Regum
 Digna domus! Trini nomine digna Dei
 O nimium Cereris cumulati munere campi,
 Posthabitis Ennæ quos colit illa jugis!
 O sacri fontes! et sacræ vatibus umbræ
 Quas recreant avium Pieridumque chori!
 O Camus! Phœbo multus quo grator amnis
 Amnibus auriferis invidiosus inops!
 Ah mihi si vestræ reddat bona gaudia sedis,
 Detque Deus doctâ posse quiete frui!
 Qualis eram cum me tranquilla mente sedentem
 Vidisti in ripâ, Came serene, tuâ;
 Mulcentem audisti puerili flumina cantu;
 Ille quidem immerito, sed tibi gratus erat.
 Nam, memini ripa cum tu dignatus utrâque
 Dignatum est totum verba referre nemus.
 Tunc liquidis tacitisque simul mea vita diebus,
 Et similis vestræ candida fluxit aquæ.
 At nunc cœnosæ luces, atque obice multo
 Rumpitur ætatis turbidus ordo meæ.
 Quid mihi Sequanâ opus, Tamesisve aut Thybridis undâ?
 Tu potis es nostram tollere, Came, sitim."

*Elegia dedicatoria, ad illustrissimam Academiam
 Cantabrigiensem, prefixed to Cowley's Works,
 Lond. 1669, folio.*

RT.

Warmington, Sept. 8. 1851.

Minor Notes.

Ὑπὸ πλάζω.

—I "keep under my body," &c. 1 Cor. ix. 27. One can scarcely allude to this passage without remembering the sarcastic observations of Dr. South upon a too literal interpretation of it. (*Sermons*, vol. i. p. 12. Dublin, 1720.) And yet deeper and more spiritual writers by no means pass the literal interpretation by with indifference. Bishop Andrewes distinctly mentions ὑπωπιασμός, or *suggillatio*, amongst the "circumstantiæ orationis;" as also ἐκδίκησις, *vindicta*, or *revenge*, 2 Cor. vii. II. (*Preces Privatæ*, pag. 14. Londini, 1828.) Bishop J. Taylor is equally explicit in a well-known and remarkable passage:

"If the lust be upon us, and sharply tempting, by inflicting any smart to overthrow the strongest passion by the most violent pain, we shall find great ease for the present, and the resolution and apt sufferance against the future danger; and this was St. Paul's remedy: 'I bring my body under;' he used some rudeness towards it."—*Holy Living*, sect. iii. *Of Chastity. Remedies against Uncleaness*, 4.

The word ὑπόπια occurs only once in the LXX, but that seems in a peculiarly apposite way: "ὕπῳ πια καὶ συντρίμματα συναντᾷ κακοῖς, πληγαὶ δὲ εἰς ταμιεῖα κοιλίας." As our English version translates it: "The blueness of a wound cleanseth away evil (or, is a purging medicine against evil, margin), so do stripes the inward parts of the belly." (Proverbs xx. 30.) If it were not absolute presumption to differ from the great Dr. Jackson, one would feel inclined to question, or at least to require further proof of some observations of his. He says, in treating of our present passage:

"The very literal importance of those three words in the original—ὑποπιάζω, κηρῦξας, and ἀδόκιμος—cannot be so well learned from any Dictionary or Lexicon, as from such as write of the Olympic Games, or of that kind of tryal of masteries, which in his time or before was in use. The word ὑποπιάζω is proper (I take it) unto wrestlers, whose practice it was to keep under other men's bodies, not their own, or to keep their antagonists from all advantage of hold, either gotten or aimed at. But our apostle did imitate their practice upon his own body, not on any others; for his own body was his chief antagonist."—*Works*, vol. ii. p. 644. Lond. 1673.

Suidas makes some remarks upon the word, but they are not very much to our purpose.

RT.

Warmington.

Meaning of Whitsunday.

—I long ago suggested in your pages that Whitsun Day, or, as it was anciently written, Witson Day, meant Wisdom Day, or the day of the outpouring of Divine wisdom; and I requested the attention of your learned correspondents to this subject. I cannot refrain from thanking C. H. for his fourth quotation from Richard Rolle (Vol. iv., p. 50.) in confirmation of this view.

"This day *witsonday* is cald,
For *wisdom* & *wit* seuene fald
Was youen to þ^e apostles as þis day
For *wise* in alle þingis wer thay,
To spek w^t outen mannes lore
Al maner langage eueri whore."

H. T. G.

Anagrammatic Pun by William Oldys.

—Your correspondent's Query concerning Oldys's *Account of London Libraries* (Vol. iv., p. 176.), reminded me of the following punning anagram on the name of that celebrated bibliographer, which may claim a place among the first productions of its class. It was Oldys himself, and is attached to one of his own transcripts in the British Museum:

"In word and *Will I am* a friend to you,
And one friend *Old is* worth a hundred new."

BLOWEN.

Ballad of Chevy Chase: Ovid.

—Addison, in his critique on the ballad of "Chevy Chase," after quoting the stanza—

"Against Sir Hugh Montgomery,
So right his shaft he set,
The grey goose wing that was thereon
In his heart's blood was wet,"

says that "the thought" in that stanza "was never touched by any other poet, and is such a one as would have shined in Homer or Virgil." It is perhaps true that there is no passage in any other writer exactly resembling this, but it is not quite true that the thought has not been *touched*; for there is something approaching to it in Ovid's *Metamorphoses*, where the slaughter of Niobe's children by the arrows of Apollo is described:

"Altera per jugulum *pennis tenuis* acta sagitta est:
Expulit hanc sanguis; seque ejaculatus in altum
Emicat."—vi. 260.

The author of this ballad would appear, from the passages cited by Addison, to have been well read in the Latin poets. Had Addison recollected the above passage of Ovid, he would doubtless have adduced it.

J. S. W.

Stockwell.

Horace Walpole at Eton.

—The following anecdote of Horace Walpole while at Eton was related by the learned Jacob Bryant, one of his school-fellows, and has not, I believe, been printed; it is at all events very much at your service.

In those days the Etonians were in the habit of acting plays, and amongst others *Tamerlane* was selected for representation. The cast of parts has unluckily not been preserved, but it is sufficient for us to know that the lower boys were put into requisition to personate the mutes. After the performance the wine, which had been provided for the actors, had disappeared, and a strong suspicion arose that the lower boys behind the scenes had made free with it, and Horace Walpole exclaimed, "The mutes have swallowed the liquids!"

BRAYBROOKE.

Queries.

CONTINENTAL WATCHMEN AND THEIR SONGS.

The inquiries I made in Vol. iii., p. 324., respecting the Bellman and his Songs, have been answered by most interesting information (pp. 377. 451. 485.); and the references made by the Editor to V. Bourne's translation was most acceptable. The interest of this subject is increased by finding that the Custos Nocturnus exists at the present day in other countries, resembling very much in duties, costume, and chants the Westminster Bellman. I venture to send you extracts from W. Hurton's *Voyage from Leith to Lapland*, and Dr. Forbes's *Physician's Holiday*.

"During the past year of 1849 it has been my lot to reside at four of the most remarkable capitals of Europe, and successively to experience what spring is in London, what summer is in Paris, what autumn is in Edinburgh, and what winter is in Copenhagen. Vividly, indeed, can I dwell on the marvellous contrast of the night aspect of each: but one of the most interesting peculiarities I have noticed in any of them, is that presented by the watchmen of the last-named. When I first looked on these guardians of the night, I involuntarily thought of Shakspeare's Dogberry and Verges. The sturdy watchers are muffled in uniform great coats, and also wear fur caps. In their hand they carry a staff of office, on which they screw, when occasion requires, that fearful weapon the 'morning star.' They also sometimes may be seen with a lanthorn at their belt: the candle contained in the lanthorn they place at the top of their staff, to relight any street-lamps which require trimming. In case of fire, the watchmen give signals from the church towers, by striking a number of strokes, varying with the quarter of the city in which the fire occurs; and they also put from the tower flags and lights pointed in the direction where the destructive element is raging. From eight o'clock in the evening, until four (Query, until five) o'clock in the morning, all the year round, they chant a fresh verse at the expiration of each hour, as they go their rounds. The cadence is generally deep and guttural, but with a peculiar emphasis and tone; and from a distance it floats on the still night air with a pleasing and impressive effect, especially to the ear of a stranger. The verses in question are of great antiquity, and were written, I am told, by one of the Danish bishops. They are printed on a large sheet of paper, with an emblematical border, rudely engraved in the old style; and in the centre is a large engraving exactly representing one of the ancient watchmen, in the now obsolete costume, with his staff and 'morning star' in hand, a lanthorn at his belt, and his dog at his feet.

"A copy of the broadside has been procured me, and my friend Mr. Charles Beckwith has expressly made for me a verbatim translation of the verses; and his version I will now give at length. I am induced to do this, because, not only are the chants most interesting in themselves, as a fine old relic of Scandinavian customs, but there seems to me a powerful poetical spirit pervading them. At the top of the sheet are the lines which in the translation are—

'Watch and pray,
For time goes;
Think and directly,
You know not when.'

"In large letters over the engraving of the watchman are the words (translated):

'Praised be God! our Lord, to whom

Be love, praise, and honour.'

"I will now give the literal version, printed exactly in the same arrangement of lines, letters, and punctuation, as the original:

'*Copenhagen Watchman's Song.*

Eight o'clock,
When darkness blinds the earth
And the day declines,
That time then us reminds
Of death's dark grave;
Shine on us, Jesus sweet,
At every step
To the grave-place,
And grant a blissful death.'

"Every hour between eight and five o'clock inclusive has its own chant. The last is—

'Five o'clock.
O Jesu! morning star!
Our King unto thy care
We so willingly commend,
Be Thou his sun and shield!
Our clock it has struck five
Come mild Sun,
From mercy's pale,
Light up our house and home.'"

Voyage from Leith to Lapland in 1850,
by W. Hurton, vol. i. p. 104.

Dr. Forbes writes:

"We had very indifferent rest in our inn, owing to the over-zeal of the Chur watchmen, whose practice it is to perambulate the town through the whole night, twelve in number, and who on the present occasion displayed a most energetic state of vigilance. They not only called, but sung out, every hour, in the most sonorous strains, and even chanted a long string of verses on the striking of some.... I suppose the good people of Chur think nothing of these chantings, or from habit hear them not; but a tired traveller would rather run the risk of being robbed in tranquillity, than be thus sung from his propriety during all the watches of the night."—*A Physician's Holiday*, pp. 80, 81.

Dr. Forbes gives a copy of a "Watch Chant at Chur," with a translation, pp. 81, 82. At p. 116. he says:

"In our hotel at Altorf we were again saluted, during the vigils of the night, but in a very mitigated degree, with some of the same patriotic and pious strains which had so disturbed us at Chur. As chanted here, however, they were far from unwelcome. The only other place, I think, where we heard these Wächterrufe was Neufchatel. These calls are very interesting relics of the old times, and must be considered indicative as well of the simple habits of the old time, as of the pious feelings of the people of old."

He then gives the Evening and Morning Chants in the town of Glarus, and the chant in use in some places in the canton of Zurich; but in Zurich itself the chant is no longer heard.

Dr. Forbes concludes the twelfth chapter with the following observation:

"The same antiquity, and also the inveteracy of old customs to persist, is strikingly shown by the fact that in some parts of the canton of Tessino, where the common language of the people is Italian, the night watch-call is still in old German."

The apparent universality of the Bellman throughout Europe gives rise to questions that would, I apprehend, extend beyond the object of "NOTES AND QUERIES;" such as, Is pure religion benefited by the engrafting of it upon stocks so familiar as the bellman or watchman? What are the causes that the old ecclesiastic bellman is no longer heard in some countries, whilst in others he continues with little or no variation? Has religion lost or gained by the change?

Dr. Forbes's notice of the Tessino watchman calls up the public crier in England, another class of bellmen, asking for a hearing, with his "O yes! O yes!" Little does he think that he is speaking French.

F. W. J.

Minor Queries.

151. *Quotation from Bacon.*

—In Lord Campbell's *Life of Lord Bacon (Lives of the Lord Chancellors, vol. ii. p. 314.)* he gives an extract from Lord Bacon's speech in the House of Commons, on his proposed bill for "Suppressing Abuses in Weights and Measures." In the following sentence there is a word which seems to require explanation:

"The fault of using false weights and measures is grown so intolerable and common, that if you would build churches you shall not need for battlements and *halls*, other than false weights of lead and brass."

The use of lead for the battlements of churches seems obvious enough: but what can *halls* mean, unless it be a misprint for *bells*, for which brass would be required?

PEREGRINUS.

152. *Carmagnoles.*

—Can any of your readers tell me the exact meaning of the *Carmagnoles* of the French Revolution? Is the "Marseillaise" a Carmagnole song? If the word be derived from Carmagnuola in Piedmont, what is the story of its origin?

W. B. H.

153. *The Use of Tobacco by the Elizabethan Ladies.*

—In *An Introduction to English Antiquities, by James Eccleston, B.A., 8vo. 1847, p. 306.,* the author, speaking of the ladies of the reign of Elizabeth, has the following passage:

"It is with regret we add, that their teeth were at this time generally black and rotten, a defect which foreigners attributed to their inordinate love for sugar, but which may, perhaps, be quite as reasonably ascribed to their frequent habit of taking the Nicotian weed to excess."

Does the author mean to insinuate by the above, that the Elizabethan ladies indulged in the "filthy weed" by "smoking" or "chewing?" I have always understood that the "Nicotian weed" *whitened* the teeth rather than *blackened* them, but should be glad to be enlightened upon the subject by some of your scientific readers.

EDWARD F. RIMBAULT.

154. *Covines* (Vol. iii., p. 477.).

—Remembering to have seen it stated by one of your correspondents, that witches or sorcerers were formerly divided into classes or companies of twelve, called *covines*, I should feel obliged by a reference to the authorities from which this statement is derived. They were not alleged at the time.

A. N.

155. *Story referred to by Jeremy Taylor.*

—Jeremy Taylor (*Duct. Dubit.*, book iii. chap. ii. rule 5. quæst. 2.) states:

"The Greek that denied the depositum of his friend, and offered to swear at the altar that he had restored it already, did not preserve his conscience and his oath by desiring his friend to hold the staff in which he had secretly conveyed the money. It is true, he delivered it into his hand, desiring that he would hold it till he had sworn; but that artifice was a plain cozenage, and it was prettily discovered. For the injured person, in indignation at the perjury, smote the staff upon the ground, and broke it, and espied the money."

Whence is the above incident derived?

A TR.

156. *Plant in Texas.*

—I shall be glad to learn the scientific name of the plant to which the following extract from the *Athenæum* (1847, p. 210.) refers:—

"It is a well-known fact that in the vast prairies of Texas a little plant is always to be found which, under all circumstances of climate, changes of weather, rain, frost, or sunshine, invariably turns its leaves and flowers to the north," &c.

.N.D

157. *Discount.*

—Can any of your readers inform me how discount originated, and where first made use of?

JAMES C.

158. *Sacre Cheveux.*

—The motto of the arms of the family of *Halifax* of Chadacre in Suffolk, and of Lombard Street, is—

"SACRE CHEVEUX."

It does not seem to bear allusion to the crest, a griffin, nor to any of the charges in the coat, which I do not at the moment accurately remember. If you will enlighten me as to the meaning and origin of the motto, I shall be obliged.

S. A.

159. "*Mad as a March Hare.*"

—In Mr. Mayhew's very interesting work, *London Labour and the London Poor*, Part xxxiii. p. 112., a collector of hareskins, in giving an account of his calling, says:

"Hareskins is in—leastways I c'lects them—from September to the end of March, when hares, they says, goes mad."

Perhaps the allusion to the well-known saying, "as mad as a March hare," on this occasion was made without the collector of hareskins being aware of the existence of such a saying. Is anything known of its origin? I imagine that Mr. Mayhew's work will bring many such sayings to light.

L. L. L.

160. *Vermin, Payments for Destruction of, and Ancient Names.*

—Can you afford me any information as to the authority (act of parliament, or otherwise,) by which churchwardens in old times paid sums of money for the destruction of vermin in the several parishes in England; and by what process of reasoning, animals now deemed innocuous were then thought to merit so rigorous an extirpation?

In some old volumes of churchwardens' accounts to which I have access, I find names which it is impossible to associate with any description of vermin now known. Perhaps some of your correspondents may be able to identify them: such as *glead*, *ringteal*, *greas'head*, *baggar*. My own impression as to the latter name was, that it was only another way of spelling badger; but as, in the volume to which I refer, the word *bowson* occurs, which the historian Dr. Whitaker pronounces to be identical with that species of vermin, my surmise can scarcely be correct.

J. B. (Manchester).

161. *Fire unknown.*

—Leibnitz (*Sur l'Entendement humain*, liv. i. § 4.) speaks of certain islanders to whom fire was unknown. Is there any authentic account of savages destitute of this essential knowledge?

C. W. G.

162. *Matthew Paris's Historia Minor.*

—During the last few years I have made occasional, but unsuccessful, inquiries after the *Historia Minor* of Matthew Paris. It is quoted at some length by Archbishop Parker (*Antiquit. Eccles. Brit.*, ed. Hanov. 1605, p. 158.). It is also referred to, apparently upon Parker's authority, by several divines of the succeeding age; by one or more of whom (as well as by Watt) the MS. is spoken of as deposited in the Royal Library at St. James's. The words produced by Parker do not occur in Matthew Paris's *Major History*; though the editor of the second edition of the larger work would appear to have consulted the *Hist. Minor*, either in the *Biblioth. Reg.*, or the Cottonian Library, or else in the Library of Corpus Coll., Cambridge. Can any one gratify my curiosity by saying whether this MS. is known to exist, and (if so) where?

J. SANSOM.

163. *Mother Bunche's Fairy Tales.*

—Who wrote *Mother Bunche's Fairy Tales*?

DALSTONIA.

164. *Monumental Symbolism.*

—In the south aisle of Tylehurst church, Berks, is a beautiful monument to the memory of Sir Peter Vanlore, Knight, and his lady, in recumbent positions, at whose feet is the statue of their eldest son in armour kneeling. In the front of the tomb are the figures of ten of their children in processional form—first, two daughters singly; the rest two and two, four of which have skulls in their right hands, and a book in their left, probably to denote their being deceased at the time the monument was erected. At the feet of one of the youngest children is represented a very small figure of a child lying in a shroud, the date 1627.

Query, What do the books symbolise?

JULIA R. BOCKETT.

Southcote Lodge.

165. *Meaning of "Stickle" and "Dray."*

—In Wm. Browne's *Pastoral*, "The Squirrel Hunt," we read of—

"Patient anglers, standing all the day
Near to some shallow *stickle*, or deep bay."

The word *stickle* appears to me to be used here for a pool. Is it ever so used now, or has that meaning become obsolete? I do not find it in Richardson's *Dictionary*.

In the Lake District, in the Langdales, is Harrison's Stickle or Stickle Tarn, which I think confirms my view of the meaning.

"Whilst he from tree to tree, from spray to spray,
Gets to the wood, and hides him in his *dray*."

Cowper uses the word *dray* with reference to the same animal:

"Chined like a squirrel to his *dray*."
"A Fable," Southey's *Edit.* viii. 312.

What is the correct meaning of this word? Richardson, from Barrett, says, "a *dray* or *sledde*, which goeth without wheels." And adds, "also applied to a carriage with low, heavy wheels, dragged heavily along, as a brewer's *dray*."

He then quotes the passage from Cowper, containing the above line.

F. B. RELTON.

166. *Son of the Morning*.—

"Son of the morning, rise! approach you here!
Come—but molest not yon defenceless urn:
Look on this spot—a nation's sepulchre!
Abode of gods, whose shrines no longer burn.
Even gods must yield—religions take their turn:
'Twas Jove's—'tis Mahomet's—and other creeds
Will rise with other years, till man shall learn
Vainly his incense soars, his victim bleeds;
Poor child of Doubt and Death, whose hope is built on reeds."

How many read the above beautiful stanza from *Childe Harold*, Canto II. Stanza 3., without asking themselves who the "Son of the morning" is. Perhaps some of your literary correspondents and admirers of Byron may be able to tell us. I enclose my own solution for your information.

AN OLD BENGAL CIVILIAN.

167. *Gild Book*.

—The Gild-Book of the "Holy Trinity Brotherhood" of St. Botolph's without Aldersgate, London, once belonged to Mr. W. Hone, by whom it is quoted in his *Ancient Mysteries*, p. 79. If any of the readers of "NOTES AND QUERIES" would be so kind as to let me know where this MS. is to be found, I should be very thankful.

D. ROCK.

Buckland, Faringdon.

Replies.

POPE AND FLATMAN. (Vol. iv., p. 132.)

In the edition of Pope's *Works* published by Knapton, Lintot, and others, 1753, 9 vols., I find the following note to the Ode entitled "The Dying Christian to his Soul:"—

"This Ode was written in imitation of the famous Sonnet of Hadrian to his departing Soul, but as much superior to his original in sense and sublimity as the Christian religion is to the pagan."

This is confirmed by the correspondence of Pope with Steele, vol. vii. pp. 185, 188, 189, 190. Letters 4, 7, 8, and 9.

That Pope also derived some hints at least from Flatman's Ode is, I think, certain, from the following extract from a bookseller's catalogue of a few years' date:

"Flatman, Thos., Poems and Songs. Portrait slightly damaged. 8vo., new, cf. gt. back, 8s. With autograph of Alex. Pope.

"MS. Note at p. 55.—"This next piece, *A Thought on Death*, is remarkable as being the verses from which Pope borrowed some of the thoughts in his Ode of The Dying Christian to his Soul."

F. B. RELTON.

The question whether Flatman borrowed from Pope or Pope from Flatman (the former seems far more probable) may perhaps be decided by the date of Flatman's composition, if that can be ascertained. Pope's ode was composed in November, 1712, as recorded in the interesting series of letters in the correspondence between Pope and Steele (*Letters* iv. to ix.) and in the 532nd number of the *Spectator*. From Steele's letter it appears that the stanzas were composed for music: is any setting of them known, anterior to that by Harwood, which has obtained such universal popularity, in spite of its many undeniable errors in harmony? Is anything known of this composer? he certainly was not deficient either in invention or taste, and must have written other pieces worthy to be remembered.

E. V.

It seems probable that the coincidence between the passages of Thomas Flatman and Pope, indicated at p. 132., arises from both imitating the *alliteration* of the original:

"*Animula, vagula, blandula,*
Hospes, comesque corporis,
Quæ nunc abibis in loca,
Pullidula, rigida, undula?
Nec, ut soles, dabis jocos."

Casaubon (*Hist. Ang. Script.*, t. i. p. 210. ed. Lug. Bat.) has totally lost sight of this in his Greek translation.

THEODORE BUCKLEY.

TEST OF STRENGTH OF A BOW. (Vol. iv., p. 56.)

Although unable to answer all the Queries of *TOXOPHILUS*, the subjoined information may possibly advantage him. His Queries of course have reference to the long bow, and not to the arbalest, or cross-bow. The length of this bow appears to have varied according to the height and strength of the bowman; for in the 12th year of the reign of Edward IV. an act was passed ordaining that every Englishman should be possessed of a bow of his own height. Bishop Latimer also, in one of his sermons, preached before Edward VI., and published in 1549, wherein he enforces the practice of archery, has the following passage:

"In my time my father taught me how to draw, how to lay my body in my bow, and not to draw with strength of arms, as other nations do, but with strength of body. I had my bows brought me according to my age and strength: as I increased in them, so my bows were made bigger and bigger."

The length of the full-sized bow appears to have been about six feet: the arrow, three.

The distance to which an arrow could be shot from the long bow of course depended, in a great measure, upon the quality and toughness of the wood, as well as upon the skill and strength of the archer; but I believe it will be found that the tougher and more unyielding the bow, the greater the strength required in bending it, and consequently the greater the force imparted to the arrow. The general distance to which an arrow could be shot from the long bow seems to have been from eleven to twelve score yards; although there are instances on record of individuals shooting from 400 to 500 yards.

The best bows used by our ancestors were made of yew, as it appears from a statute made in the thirty-third year of the reign of Henry VIII., by which it was enacted—

"That none under the age of seventeen should shoot with a bow of yew, except his parents were worth 10*l.* per annum in lands, or 40 marks in goods: and for every bow made of yew, the bowyer not inhabiting London or the suburbs should make four, and the inhabitant there two, bows of other wood."

These restrictions were doubtless owing to the great scarcity of yew. The other woods most in request were elm, witch-hazel, and ash. By the statute 8th of Elizabeth, cap 3., it was ordained that every bowyer residing in London should have always ready fifty bows of either of the before-mentioned woods. By this statute also the prices at which the bows were to be sold were regulated.

I believe the ancient bows were made of one piece; whether there is any advantage to be derived in having a bow of more than two pieces, I leave for some one better qualified than myself to determine.

As regards arrows, Ascham, in his *Toxophilus*, has enumerated fifteen sorts of wood of which arrows were made in his time, viz. brasell, turkie-wood, fusticke, sugercheste, hard-beam, byrche, ash, oak, service-tree, alder, blackthorn, elder, beach, aspe, and sallow; of these aspe and ash were accounted the best; the one for target-shooting, the other for war. The author of *The Field Book* says:

"That an arrow weighing from twenty to four-and-twenty pennyweights, made of yew, was considered by archers the best that could be used."

DAVID STEVENS.

Godalming.

The method of trying and proving a bow is stated by Ascham to be thus:

"By shooting it in the fields, and *sinking* it with *dead heavy* shafts; looking where it *comes* most, and providing for that place betimes, lest it pinch and so fret. When the bow has thus been shot in, and appears to contain good shooting wood, it must be taken to a skilful workman, to be cut shorter, scraped, and dressed fitter, and made to come circularly round; and it should be whipped at the ends, lest it snap in sunder or fret sooner than the archer is aware of."

It is calculated that an arrow may be shot 110 yards for every 20 lbs. weight of the bow.

As regards the length of the old English bow, the statute 5th of Edward IV. cap. 4., runs thus:

"That every Englishman, and Irishmen that dwell with Englishmen and speak English, that be between sixteen and sixty in age, shall have an English bow of his own length."

Ascham recommended for men of average strength arrows made of birch, hornbeam, oak, and ash.

The foregoing is extracted from a work entitled *The English Bowman*, by T. Roberts, 1801.

PHILOSOPHUS.

BASKERVILLE THE PRINTER. (Vol. iv., pp. 40. 123.)

Hansard's *Typographia*, i. 8vo. 1825, Preface, p. xii—xiii.:

"Of the more modern portraits something remains to be said, and particularly of that of Baskerville. It has been hitherto supposed that no likeness is extant of this first promoter of fine printing, and author of various improvements in the Typographic Art, as well as in the arts connected with it. At the time when I was collecting information for that part of my work in which Mr. Baskerville is particularly mentioned (p. 310. *et seq.*), I thought it a good opportunity to make inquiry at Birmingham whether any portrait or likeness of him remained; for a long time the inquiry was constantly answered in the negative, but at last it occurred to a friend to make a search among the family of the late Mrs. Baskerville, and he was successful. Mr. Baskerville married the widow of a Mr. Eaves; her maiden name was Ruston; she had two children by her former husband, a son and a daughter: the latter married her first cousin, Mr. Josiah Ruston, formerly a respectable druggist at Birmingham, and she survived her husband. At the sale of some effects after her decease, portraits of her mother and her father-in-law, Mr. Baskerville, were purchased by Mr. Knott of Birmingham. Some of Mr. Ruston's family and friends who are still living, consider this likeness of Mr. Baskerville as a most excellent and faithful resemblance. It was taken by one Miller, an artist of considerable eminence in the latter part of Baskerville's time. The inquiries of my friend Mr. Grafton, of Park Grove, near Birmingham, at once brought this painting into notice: and at his solicitation Mr. Knott kindly permitted Mr. Raven of Birmingham, an artist of much celebrity, to copy it for my use and the embellishment of this work; to which, I think, the united talents of Mr. Craig and Mr. Lee have done ample justice."

The portrait faces p. 310. of Mr. Hansard's book, and there may be found an account, though somewhat different, of the exhumation alluded to by MR. ST. JOHNS (Vol. iv., p. 123.), which took place in May, 1821.

CRANMORE.

In answer to an inquirer I beg respectfully to state that the body of the eminent printer now reposes, as it has for some years, in the vaults of Christ Church in our town.

WILLIAM CORNISH.

New Street, Birmingham.

Replies to Minor Queries.

Mazer Wood and Sin-eaters (Vol. iii., pp. 239. 288.).

—The following extract from Hone's *Year Book*, p. 858., will add to the explanation furnished by S. S. S., and will also give an instance of the singular practices which prevailed among our ancestors:—

"Among the Lansdowne MSS. in the British Museum are statements in Aubrey's own handwriting to this purport. In the county of Hereford, was an old custom at funerals, to hire poor people, who were to take upon them the sins of the party deceased. One of them (he was a long, lean, ugly, lamentable, poor rascal), I remember, lived in a cottage on Rosse highway. The manner was, that when the corpse was brought out of the house, and laid on the bier, a loaf of bread was brought out, and delivered to the sin eater, over the corpse, as also a *mazard bowl* of maple, full of beer (which he was to drink up), and sixpence in money, in consideration whereof he took upon him, *ipso facto*, all the sins of the defunct, and freed him or her from walking after they were dead."

Perhaps some of your readers may be able to throw some light on this curious practice of *sin-eating*, or on the existence of regular *sin-eaters*.

E. H. B.

Demerary.

[Mr. Ellis, in his edition of Brande's *Popular Antiquities*, vol. ii. p. 155. 4to. has given a curious passage from the Lansdowne MSS. concerning a sin-eater who lived in Herefordshire, which has been quoted in the *Gentleman's Magazine*, vol. xcii. pt. i. p. 222.]

"*A Posie of other Men's Flowers*" (Vol. iv., pp. 58. 125.).

—If D. Q. should succeed in finding this saying in Montaigne's Works, I hope he will be kind enough to send an "Eureka!" to "NOTES AND QUERIES," as by referring to pp. 278. 451. of your second volume he will see that I am interested in the question.

I am still inclined to think that the metaphor, *in its present concise form* at all events, does *not* belong to Montaigne, though it may owe its origin to some passage in the *Essays*. See, for example, one in book i. chap. 24.; another in book ii. chap. 10., in Hazlitt's second edition, 1845, pp. 54. 186.

But I have not forgotten Montaigne's motto, "Que sçais-je?" The chances are that I am wrong. I should certainly like to see his right to the saying satisfactorily proved by reference to book, chapter, and page.

C. FORBES.

Temple.

At the conclusion of the preface to the thick 8vo. edition of the *Elegant Extracts, Verse*, published by C. Dilly, 1796, you will find these words:—

"I will conclude my preface with the *ideas of Montaigne*. 'I have here only made a nosegay of culled flowers, and have brought nothing of my own but the thread that ties them.'"

R. S. S.

56. Fenchurch Street.

Table Book (Vol. i., p. 215.).

—See *Transactions of the Royal Irish Academy*, vol. xxi., Antiq. pp. 3-15, and some specimens in the museum of the Academy. (*Proceedings*, vol. iii. p. 74.)

R. H.

Briwingable (Vol. iv., p. 22.).

—I cannot find this word in any authority to which I have access. I derive it from

briþan Eafel

Sax. {briþan}, to brew, and {Eafel}, a tax; and think it the same as *tolsester*, a duty payable to the lord of the manor by ale-brewers, mentioned in Charta 55 Hen. III.: "Tolsester cerevisie, hec est pro quolibet braccino per annum unam lagenam cerevisie."

F. J.

Simnels (Vol. iii., pp. 390. 506.).

—T. very sensibly suggests that Lambert *Simnel* is a nickname derived from a kind of cake still common in the north of England, and eaten in Lent. I have never met with *Simnel* as a surname, and have actually been told, as a child, that the Simnels were called after Lambert; which is so far worthy of note as that it connects the two together in tradition, though, no doubt, as T. suggests, it is Lambert who was called after the Simnels. As a child I took the liberty to infer, in consequence, that Parkins (gingerbread of oatmeal instead of flour, and also common in the north of England) were called after Perkin Warbeck. I am aware of the superior claim of Peterkin now; but the coincidence may perhaps amuse your correspondents.

†

A Ship's Berth (Vol. iv., p. 83.).

—I would suggest to your correspondents S. S. S. (2) another derivation for our word *berth*.

The present French *berceau*, a cradle, was in the Norman age written *ber3*, as appears in a MSS. *Life of St. Nicholas* in the Bodleian Library. This Life has been printed at Bonn by Dr. Nicolaus Delius, 1850; but in the print the character 3 has been represented by the ordinary z. This is a pity, because, as all know who are familiar with our MSS. of the twelfth and thirteenth centuries, this figure 3 took not unfrequently the place of ð (th); and on this account it is a character which ought to be scrupulously preserved in editing. *Ber3* then was probably pronounced *berth*, or possibly with a little more of the sibilant than is now found in the latter. How easily the *sibilant* and the *th* run into one another may be seen by the third person singular of our present Indicative:

saith	says.
doth	does.
hopeth	hopes.

J. E.

Oxford, August 2. 1851.

Suicides buried in Cross-roads (Vol. iv., p. 116.).

—P. M. M. makes inquiry respecting a practice formerly observed of *burying murderers in cross-roads*. I have often heard that *suicides* were formerly interred in such places, and that a stake used to be driven through the body. I know of two places in the neighbourhood of *Boston* in Lincolnshire, where such burials are stated to have taken place. One of these is about a mile and a half south of Boston, on what is called the *low road* to Freiston; a very ancient *hawthorn tree* marks the spot, and the tree itself is said to have sprung from the stake which was driven through the body of the self-murderer. The tradition was told me sixty years since, and the interment was *then* said to have occurred *a hundred years ago*; the suicide's name was at that time traditionally remembered, and was told to me, but I cannot recall it. The tree exhibits marks of great age, and is preserved with care; it still bears "may," as the flower of the whitethorn is called, and *haws* in their season.

The second grave (as it is reported) of this kind is on the high road from Boston to Wainfleet, at the intersection of a road leading to Butterwick, at a place called *Spittal Hill*; near the site of the ancient hospital or infirmary, which was attached to the Priory of St. James at Freiston. This spot is famous in the traditions of the

neighbourhood as the scene of the appearance of a sprite or hobgoblin, called the "*Spittal Hill Tut*;" which takes, in the language of the district, the shape of a *SHAG foal*, and is said to be connected with the history of the suicide buried there.

TUT is a very general term applied in Lincolnshire to any fancied supernatural appearance. Children are frightened by being told of *Tom Tut*; and persons in a state of panic, or unreasonable trepidation, are said to be *Tut-gotten*.

P. T.

Stoke Newington, Aug. 30.

A Sword-blade Note (Vol. iv., p. 176.).

—The sword-blade note, to which R. J. refers, was doubtless a note of the Sword-blade Company, which was intimately connected with the South Sea Company. In the narrative respecting the latter company, given in *The Historical Register* for 1720, is an account of a conference between the South Sea Directors and those of the Bank of England: therein is the following passage:

"And when it was urg'd that the *Sword Blade* Company should come into the Treaty; *By no means*, reply'd *Sir Gilbert* [Heathcote]; *for if the South Sea Company be wedded to the Bank, he ought not to be allow'd to keep a Mistress*. The Event show'd that the Bank acted with their usual Prudence, in not admitting the *Sword Blade* Company into a Partnership."—*Historical Register* for 1720, p. 368.

At p. 377. of the same work it is stated, that on the 24th of September the Sword-blade Company, "who hitherto had been the chief cash keepers to the South Sea Company," stopped payment, "being almost drain'd of their ready money."

Perhaps some of your correspondents may be able to elucidate the rise, transactions, and "winding up" of the Sword-blade Company.

C. H. COOPER.

Cambridge, Sept. 6. 1851.

Domesday Book of Scotland (Vol. iv., p. 7.).

—Your correspondent ABERDONIENSIS is informed that what he is in quest of was published by the "Bannatyne Club," under the name of the "Ragman Rolls," in 1834, 4to. It is entitled, *Instrumenta Publica sive Processus super Fidelitatibus et Homagiis Scotorum Domino Regi Angliæ factis*, A.D. M.CC.XCI.—M.CC.XCVI.

"The documents contained in this volume have not been selected in the view of reviving or illustrating the ancient National Controversy as to the feudal dependence of Scotland on the English Crown. It has been long known that in these Records may be found the largest and most authentic enumerations now extant of the Nobility, Barons, Landholders and Burgesses, as well as of the Clergy of Scotland, prior to the fourteenth century. No part of the public Records of Scotland prior to that era has been preserved, and whatever may have been their fate, certain it is, that to these English Records of our temporary national degradation, are we now indebted for the only genuine Statistical Notices of the Kingdom towards the close of the thirteenth century."

* * "This singular document, so often quoted and referred to, was never printed *in extenso*."

T. G. S.

Edinburgh.

Dole-bank (Vol. iv., p. 162.).

—In processions on Holy Thursday, it was usual to *deal* cakes and bread to the children and the poor of the parish at boundary-banks, that they might be duly remembered. Hence the name.

R. S. H.

Morwenstow.

The Letter "V" (Vol. iv., p. 164.).

—If S. S. will turn again to my remarks on this letter, he will see that I did not state that *Tiverton* was ever pronounced *Terton*. I accede to what he has said of *Twiverton*; Devonshire was inadvertently written for Somersetshire. With regard to the observations of A. N. (p. 162.), he will find those remarks were confined to the *v* between two vowels, *i.e.* without any other consonant intervening; and, therefore, other forms of contraction did not fall within the scope of them. I refrained from adverting to any such words as *Elvedon* and *Kelvedon* (pronounced respectively *Eldon* and *Keldon*), because the abbreviation of these may be referable to another cause. In passing I would mention that I think there can be no reasonable doubt that the word *dool*, about which he inquires, is no other than the Ang.-Sax. *dāl*, a division, from *daelan*, to divide; and whence our words *deal* and *dole*. But to return to the letter *v*, if MR. SINGER be correct as to *devenisch* in the MS. of the *Hermit of Hampole* being written for Danish (p. 159.), it seems an example of the peculiar use of this letter to which I have invited attention, for the writer hardly intended it to be pronounced as three syllables if he meant Danish. However, if that MS. be a transcript, may not the supposed *v* have been originally an *n*, which was first mis-read *u*, and then copied as a *v*?

W. S. W.

Cardinal Wolsey (Vol. iv., p. 176.).

—The following anecdote, taken from a common-place book of Sir Roger Wilbraham, who was Master of the Requests in the time of Queen Elizabeth, appears to have some bearing on the subject referred to in the page of your publication which I have quoted above:—

"Cooke, attorney, at diner Whitsunday ^[1] ista protulit.

"Wolsey, a prelate, was flagrante crimine taken in fornication by SR Anthony Pagett of ye West, and put in ye stokes. After being made Cardinall, SR Anthony sett up his armes on ye middle Temple gate: ye Cardinall passing in pontificalibus, and spying his owne armes, asked who sett them up. Answare was made yt ye said Mr. Pagett. He smiled saying, he is now well reclaymed; for wher before he saw him in disgrace, now he honoured him."

^[1] This was probably in 1598.

W. L.

Nervous (Vol. iv., p. 7.).

—*Nervous* has unquestionably the double meaning assigned to it in MR. BANNEL'S Query. The propriety of the English practice, in this respect, may be doubted. *Nervous* is correctly equivalent to Lat. *nervosus*; Fr. *nerveux*, strong, vigorous. In the sense of *nervous weakness*, or, perhaps more correctly, *nervine weakness*, the word should probably be *nerbish*, analogous to *qualmish*, *squeamish*, *aguish*, *feverish*, &c. In Scotland, though the English may regard it as a vulgarism, I have heard the word used in this form.

F. S. Q.

Coleridge's Essays on Beauty (Vol. iv., p. 175.).

—I have copies of the *Essays* referred to. They were republished about 1836 in Fraser's *Literary Chronicle*.

MORTIMER COLLINS.

Guernsey.

"Nao" or "Naw," a Ship (Vol. iv., p. 28.).

—I have already answered GOMER upon the imaginary word *naw*, a ship: I beg now to remark on MR. FENTON'S *nav*. If *nav* was a ship at all, I am at a loss to know why it should be "a much older term." It would probably be subsequent to the introduction of the Latin noun, which it docks of its final *is*. The word or name is quoted from a Triad, the ninety-seventh of that series which contains the mention of Llewelyn ap Griffith, the last prince of Wales; and what makes it "one of the oldest" Triads, I have no idea. Nor do I know what ascertains the date of any of them; or removes the date of the composition of any one of them beyond the middle ages.

But *Nevydd* is no very uncommon proper name of men and women, derived from *nev*, heaven; and *nav neivion* is simply "lord of lords." It forms the plural like *mab*, *meibion*, and *march*, *meirchion*. Mr. Walters gives *nav* under no words but *lord*. David ap Gwelyn either mentions the navigation of the lords, the Trojan chieftains, to Britain; or else that of *Nevydd Nav Neivion*, cutting short his title. But the former is the plain sense of the thing. If MR. FENTON will only turn to Owen's *Dictionary* (from which *naw*, a ship, is very properly excluded) he will there find the quotation from Gwalchmai; in which the three Persons of the Trinity are styled the *Undonion Neivion*, "harmonizing or consentaneous Lords." He will scarcely make bold to turn them into ships.

A. N.

Unde derivatur Stonehenge (Vol. iv., p. 57.).

—Your correspondent P. P. proposes to interpret this word, *horse-stones*, from *hengst*, the Saxon for a horse; and to understand thereby large stones, as the words *horse-chesnut*, *horse-daisy*, *horse-mushroom*, &c., mean large ones. But, if he had duly considered the arguments contained in Mr. Herbert's *Cyclops Christianus*, pp. 162-4., he would have seen the necessity of showing, that in Anglo-Saxon and English the description can follow, in composition, the thing described; which it seems it can do in neither. In support of his stone-horse, he should have produced a chesnut-horse in the vegetable sense; a daisy-horse, or a mushroom-horse. Till he does that, the grammatical canon appealed to by that author, will remain in as full force against the stone-horse as against the stone-hanging.

E. A. M.

Nick Nack (Vol. iii., p. 179.).

—A rude species of music very common amongst the boys in Sheffield, called by them *nick-a-nacks*. It is made by two pieces of bone, sometimes two pieces of wood, placed between the fingers, and beaten in time by a rapid motion of the hand and fingers. It is one of the periodical amusements of the boys going along the streets.

"And with his right drew forth a truncheon of a white ox rib, and two pieces of wood of a like form; one of black Eben, and the other of incarnation Brazile; and put them betwixt the fingers of that hand, in good symmetry. Then knocking them together, made such a noise, as the lepers of Britany use to do with their clappering clickets; yet better resounding, and far more harmonious."—*Rabelais*, book ii. c. 19.

H. J.

Meaning of Carfax (Vol. iii., p. 508.).

—E. J. S. says "Carfoix reminds me of Carfax in Oxford. Are the names akin to each other?" When at Oxford I used to hear that Carfax was properly Quarfax, a contraction for *quatuor facies*, four faces. The church, it will be remembered, looks one way to High Street, another to Queen Street, a third to the Cornmarket, and the fourth to St. Aldates's.

H. T. G.

Hand giving the Benediction (Vol. iii., p. 477.).

—Rabbi Bechai tells us of the solemn blessing in Numbers vi. 25, 26, 27., in which the name Jehovah is thrice repeated, that, when the high priest pronounced it on the people, "elevatione manuum sic digitos composuit ut TRIADA exprimerent."

W. FRASER.

Unlucky for Pregnant Women to take an Oath (Vol. iv., p. 151.).

—I beg to inform COWGILL that Irishwomen of the lower order almost invariably refuse to be sworn while pregnant. Having frequently had to administer oaths to heads of families applying for relief during the famine in Ireland in 1847-8-9, I can speak with certainty as to the fact, though I am unable to account for the origin of the superstition.

BARTANUS.

Dublin.

Borough-English (Vol. iv., p. 133.).

—*Burgh* or *Borough-English* is a custom appendant to *ancient* boroughs, such as existed in the days of Edward the Confessor and William the Conqueror, and are contained in the Book of Domesday. Taylor, in his *History of Gavelkind*, p. 102., states, that in the villages round the city of Hereford, the lands are all held in the tenure of Borough-English. There appears also to be a customary descent of lands and tenements in some places called *Borow-English*, as in Edmunton: vid. *Kitchin of Courts*, fol. 102. The custom of *Borough-English*, like that of gavelkind, and those of London and York, is still extant; and although it may have been in a great measure superseded by *deed* or *will*, yet, doubtless, instances occur in the present day of its vitality and consequent operation.

FRANCISCUS.

Date of a Charter (Vol. iv., p. 152.).

—I suspect that the charter to which MR. HAND refers, is one of the time of Henry II., and not of Henry III. The latter sent no daughter to Sicily; but Joan, the daughter of the former, was married to William, king of Sicily, in the year 1176, 22 Henry II. In the Great Roll of that year (Rot. 13 b.) are entries of payments for hangings in the king's chamber on that occasion, and of fifty marks given to Walter de Constantiis, Archdeacon of Oxford, for entertaining the Sicilian ambassadors. See Madox's *Exchequer*, i. 367., who also in p. 18. refers to Hoveden, P. 2. p. 548. This may perhaps assist in the discovery of the precise date, which I cannot at present fix.

Φ.

Miscellaneous.

NOTES ON BOOKS, SALES, CATALOGUES, ETC.

The Jansenists: their Rise, Persecutions by the Jesuits, and existing Remnant; a Chapter in Church History: by S. P. Tregelles, LL.D., is an interesting little monograph, reprinted with additions from Dr. Kitto's *Journal of Biblical Literature*, and enriched with portraits of Jansenius, St. Cyran, and the Mère Angelique. The history of the Jansenist Church lingering in separate existence at Utrecht affords a new instance of Catholicity of doctrine apart from the Papal communion; and as such cannot fail to have a peculiar interest for many of our readers.

The long, brilliant, and important reign of Louis XIV. has had many chroniclers. The *Mémoires* written by those who figured in its busy scenes are almost innumerable; many, as may be supposed from the character of the monarch and the laxity of the court, being little calculated for general perusal. Mr. James therefore did good service when he presented the reading world with his historical view of *The Life and Times of Louis XIV.*, a work in which, while he has done full justice to the talents and genius of the monarch, and the brilliancy of the circle by which he was surrounded, he has not allowed that splendour so to dazzle the eyes of the spectator as to blind him to the real infamy and heartlessness with which it was surrounded. We are therefore well pleased to see Mr. James's history reprinted as the two new volumes of Bohn's *Standard Library*.

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WILLIS' PRICE CURRENT. Nos. I. III. V. XXIV. XXVI. XXVII.—XLV.

RABBI SALEMO JACOBES COMMENTAR ÜBER DEN PENTATEUCH VON L. HAYMANN. Bonn, 1833.

RABBI SALEMO JACOBES ÜBER DAS ERSTE BUCH MOSIS VON L. HAYMANN. Bonn, 1833.

No. 3. of SUMMER PRODUCTIONS, or PROGRESSIVE MISCELLANIES, by Thomas Johnson. London, 1790.

HISTORY OF VIRGINIA. Folio. London, 1624.

THE APOLOGETICS OF ATHENAGORAS, Englished by D. Humphreys. London, 1714. 8vo.

BOVILLUS DE ANIMÆ IMMORTALITATE, ETC. Lugduni, 1522. 4to.

KUINOEL'S NOV. TEST. Tom. I.

THE FRIEND, by Coleridge. Vol. III. Pickering.

* * Letters, stating particulars and lowest price, *carriage free*, to be sent to MR. BELL, Publisher of "NOTES AND QUERIES," 186. Fleet Street.

Notices to Correspondents.

F. R. A. *The lines referred to by DR. RIMBAULT (Vol. iv., p. 181.) are not those quoted in that page by A. TEMPLAR from the Cobleriana, but those beginning—*

"As by the Templars' holds you go,"

respecting which a Query appeared in our 3rd Vol. p. 450.

J. VARLEY, JUN. *The lines are quoted by Washington Irving, from Shakspeare's Winter's Tale, Act IV. Sc. 3.*

Rt. will perceive that his communications reach us in a very available form.

O. T. D. *is thanked for his suggestions, which shall be adopted as far as practical. He will find that his communication respecting Pallavicino has been anticipated in our 3rd Vol., pp. 478. 523.*

PHILO, *whose Query appeared in our Number of July 19th, will find a letter at our Publisher's.*

ALTRON. *There is no Agent for the sale of "NOTES AND QUERIES" in Dublin. It will however no doubt be supplied by any bookseller there from whom it may be ordered.*

REPLIES RECEIVED.—*Dr. M. Sutcliffe—Description of a Dimple—Carli the Economist—Decretorum Doctor—Versicle—Querelle d'Allemand—Ellrake—Sir W. Raleigh in Virginia—M. Lominus Theologus—Pope's Translations—Wyle Cop—Collar of SS.—What constitutes a Proverb—Visiting Cards—Going the whole Hog—Lord Mayor a Privy Councillor—Inscription on a Claymore—Queen Brunéhaut—Cagots—Written Sermons—Tale of a Tub—Cowper Law—Murderers buried in Cross-roads—Thread the Needle—Borough English—Gooseberry Fool—Darby and Joan—Print Cleaning—Serpent with a Human Head.*

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requested by some of my parishioners to lend them sermons,
which were almost *verbatim et literatim* transcripts of yours. That
you may judge of the extent to which I have been indebted to you,
I may mention that out of about seventy sermons which I preached
at W——, five or six were Paley's and fifteen or sixteen yours. For
my own credit's sake, I must add, that all the rest were entirely my
own."—*Extracted from the letter of a stranger to the Author*.

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Transcriber's Note: Original spelling varieties have not been standardized.

[Pages in "Notes and Queries", Vol. I-IV](#)

Notes and Queries Vol. I.				
Vol., No.	Date, Year	Pages	PG #	xxxxx
Vol. I No. 1	November 3, 1849	1 - 17	PG #	8603
Vol. I No. 2	November 10, 1849	18 - 32	PG #	11265
Vol. I No. 3	November 17, 1849	33 - 46	PG #	11577
Vol. I No. 4	November 24, 1849	49 - 63	PG #	13513
Vol. I No. 5	December 1, 1849	65 - 80	PG #	11636
Vol. I No. 6	December 8, 1849	81 - 95	PG #	13550
Vol. I No. 7	December 15, 1849	97 - 112	PG #	11651
Vol. I No. 8	December 22, 1849	113 - 128	PG #	11652
Vol. I No. 9	December 29, 1849	130 - 144	PG #	13521
Vol. I No. 10	January 5, 1850	145 - 160	PG #	
Vol. I No. 11	January 12, 1850	161 - 176	PG #	11653
Vol. I No. 12	January 19, 1850	177 - 192	PG #	11575
Vol. I No. 13	January 26, 1850	193 - 208	PG #	11707
Vol. I No. 14	February 2, 1850	209 - 224	PG #	13558
Vol. I No. 15	February 9, 1850	225 - 238	PG #	11929
Vol. I No. 16	February 16, 1850	241 - 256	PG #	16193
Vol. I No. 17	February 23, 1850	257 - 271	PG #	12018
Vol. I No. 18	March 2, 1850	273 - 288	PG #	13544
Vol. I No. 19	March 9, 1850	289 - 309	PG #	13638
Vol. I No. 20	March 16, 1850	313 - 328	PG #	16409
Vol. I No. 21	March 23, 1850	329 - 343	PG #	11958
Vol. I No. 22	March 30, 1850	345 - 359	PG #	12198
Vol. I No. 23	April 6, 1850	361 - 376	PG #	12505
Vol. I No. 24	April 13, 1850	377 - 392	PG #	13925
Vol. I No. 25	April 20, 1850	393 - 408	PG #	13747
Vol. I No. 26	April 27, 1850	409 - 423	PG #	13822
Vol. I No. 27	May 4, 1850	425 - 447	PG #	13712
Vol. I No. 28	May 11, 1850	449 - 463	PG #	13684
Vol. I No. 29	May 18, 1850	465 - 479	PG #	15197
Vol. I No. 30	May 25, 1850	481 - 495	PG #	13713
Notes and Queries Vol. II.				
Vol., No.	Date, Year	Pages	PG #	xxxxx
Vol. II No. 31	June 1, 1850	1- 15	PG #	12589
Vol. II No. 32	June 8, 1850	17- 32	PG #	15996
Vol. II No. 33	June 15, 1850	33- 48	PG #	26121
Vol. II No. 34	June 22, 1850	49- 64	PG #	22127
Vol. II No. 35	June 29, 1850	65- 79	PG #	22126
Vol. II No. 36	July 6, 1850	81- 96	PG #	13361
Vol. II No. 37	July 13, 1850	97-112	PG #	13729
Vol. II No. 38	July 20, 1850	113-128	PG #	13362
Vol. II No. 39	July 27, 1850	129-143	PG #	13736
Vol. II No. 40	August 3, 1850	145-159	PG #	13389
Vol. II No. 41	August 10, 1850	161-176	PG #	13393
Vol. II No. 42	August 17, 1850	177-191	PG #	13411
Vol. II No. 43	August 24, 1850	193-207	PG #	13406
Vol. II No. 44	August 31, 1850	209-223	PG #	13426
Vol. II No. 45	September 7, 1850	225-240	PG #	13427
Vol. II No. 46	September 14, 1850	241-256	PG #	13462
Vol. II No. 47	September 21, 1850	257-272	PG #	13936
Vol. II No. 48	September 28, 1850	273-288	PG #	13463
Vol. II No. 49	October 5, 1850	289-304	PG #	13480
Vol. II No. 50	October 12, 1850	305-320	PG #	13551
Vol. II No. 51	October 19, 1850	321-351	PG #	15232
Vol. II No. 52	October 26, 1850	353-367	PG #	22624
Vol. II No. 53	November 2, 1850	369-383	PG #	13540
Vol. II No. 54	November 9, 1850	385-399	PG #	22138
Vol. II No. 55	November 16, 1850	401-415	PG #	15216
Vol. II No. 56	November 23, 1850	417-431	PG #	15354
Vol. II No. 57	November 30, 1850	433-454	PG #	15405
Vol. II No. 58	December 7, 1850	457-470	PG #	21503
Vol. II No. 59	December 14, 1850	473-486	PG #	15427
Vol. II No. 60	December 21, 1850	489-502	PG #	24803
Vol. II No. 61	December 28, 1850	505-524	PG #	16404
Notes and Queries Vol. III.				
Vol., No.	Date, Year	Pages	PG #	xxxxx

Vol. III No. 62	January 4, 1851	1- 15	PG # 15638
Vol. III No. 63	January 11, 1851	17- 31	PG # 15639
Vol. III No. 64	January 18, 1851	33- 47	PG # 15640
Vol. III No. 65	January 25, 1851	49- 78	PG # 15641
Vol. III No. 66	February 1, 1851	81- 95	PG # 22339
Vol. III No. 67	February 8, 1851	97-111	PG # 22625
Vol. III No. 68	February 15, 1851	113-127	PG # 22639
Vol. III No. 69	February 22, 1851	129-159	PG # 23027
Vol. III No. 70	March 1, 1851	161-174	PG # 23204
Vol. III No. 71	March 8, 1851	177-200	PG # 23205
Vol. III No. 72	March 15, 1851	201-215	PG # 23212
Vol. III No. 73	March 22, 1851	217-231	PG # 23225
Vol. III No. 74	March 29, 1851	233-255	PG # 23282
Vol. III No. 75	April 5, 1851	257-271	PG # 23402
Vol. III No. 76	April 12, 1851	273-294	PG # 26896
Vol. III No. 77	April 19, 1851	297-311	PG # 26897
Vol. III No. 78	April 26, 1851	313-342	PG # 26898
Vol. III No. 79	May 3, 1851	345-359	PG # 26899
Vol. III No. 80	May 10, 1851	361-382	PG # 32495
Vol. III No. 81	May 17, 1851	385-399	PG # 29318
Vol. III No. 82	May 24, 1851	401-415	PG # 28311
Vol. III No. 83	May 31, 1851	417-440	PG # 36835
Vol. III No. 84	June 7, 1851	441-472	PG # 37379
Vol. III No. 85	June 14, 1851	473-488	PG # 37403
Vol. III No. 86	June 21, 1851	489-511	PG # 37496
Vol. III No. 87	June 28, 1851	513-528	PG # 37516
Notes and Queries Vol. IV.			
Vol., No.	Date, Year	Pages	PG # xxxxx
Vol. IV No. 88	July 5, 1851	1- 15	PG # 37548
Vol. IV No. 89	July 12, 1851	17- 31	PG # 37568
Vol. IV No. 90	July 19, 1851	33- 47	PG # 37593
Vol. IV No. 91	July 26, 1851	49- 79	PG # 37778
Vol. IV No. 92	August 2, 1851	81- 94	PG # 38324
Vol. IV No. 93	August 9, 1851	97-112	PG # 38337
Vol. IV No. 94	August 16, 1851	113-127	PG # 38350
Vol. IV No. 95	August 23, 1851	129-144	PG # 38386
Vol. IV No. 96	August 30, 1851	145-167	PG # 38405
Vol. IV No. 97	Sept. 6, 1851	169-183	PG # 38433
Vol. IV No. 98	Sept. 13, 1851	185-200	PG # 38491
Vol I. Index. [Nov. 1849-May 1850]			
INDEX TO THE SECOND VOLUME. MAY-DEC., 1850			PG # 13536
INDEX TO THE THIRD VOLUME. JAN.-JUNE, 1851			PG # 13571
			PG # 26770

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QUERIES, VOL. IV, NUMBER 99, SEPTEMBER 20, 1851 ***

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